

AsterLane Delivery Services Ltd

Customer Delivery and Refund Policy

Internal Knowledge Base - Fictional Training Material

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Training notice: This is fictional material created for teaching retrieval-augmented generation.

1. Purpose and scope

- This policy explains how AsterLane handles customer complaints about late, missing, damaged and incorrect deliveries. It applies to standard same-day and next-day deliveries arranged through the AsterLane platform in the United Kingdom.
- This policy does not cover international deliveries, business-to-business freight contracts, employee expenses or courier pay.

2. General support principles

- Support agents must use the order record, courier tracking events and available proof of delivery when assessing a claim.
- Agents must not promise a refund before eligibility has been checked. Where the available information is incomplete, the agent should request the missing evidence or escalate the case under the Support Escalation Guide.
- Refunds are normally returned to the customer's original payment method. Bank processing times are outside AsterLane's control.

3. Late deliveries

- A delivery is considered late when it arrives more than 30 minutes after the end of the delivery window shown in the customer's order confirmation.
- A customer may receive a refund of the delivery fee when the delivery is more than 30 minutes late and the delay was within AsterLane's or the courier's control.
- The delivery fee is not refunded when the delay was caused by severe weather, a road closure, an emergency-services incident, an incorrect address supplied by the customer, or the customer's failure to respond.
- A late delivery does not automatically qualify the customer for a refund of the value of the goods. A refund for the goods requires evidence that the goods were unusable, unsafe or materially damaged because of the delay.

4. Missing deliveries

- A customer must report a missing delivery within 48 hours of the delivery being marked as delivered.
- Before issuing a refund, the support agent must check the delivery address, delivery photograph, GPS completion point and any courier notes.
- If the proof of delivery clearly shows the parcel at the correct address or in a safe location authorised by the customer, the agent should not issue an immediate refund. The customer should first be asked to check with household members, neighbours and building reception.
- If the evidence is inconsistent, appears altered, or shows delivery to the wrong address, the case must be escalated.
- Repeated missing-delivery claims on the same account must be referred to the Risk Review queue. Support agents must not accuse the customer of fraud.

5. Damaged deliveries

- Damage must be reported within 24 hours of delivery.
- The customer should provide a clear photograph of the damaged goods and, where relevant, the external packaging.
- Minor cosmetic damage to external packaging does not qualify for a refund when the goods are intact and usable.

- Where the goods are materially damaged, leaking, broken or unsafe to use, support may offer a replacement or refund up to the order value.
- Reports involving injury, contamination, medication or an age-restricted product must be escalated immediately.

6. Incorrect or incomplete deliveries

- A customer should report an incorrect or incomplete delivery within 24 hours.
- Support may refund the value of the missing or incorrect item when the order record and available evidence support the claim.
- If the entire order belongs to another customer, support must advise the customer not to use or consume the items and must escalate the privacy incident.

7. Refund limits and exclusions

- Support agents may approve refunds up to £75 per order without team-leader approval, provided all policy conditions are met.
- Refunds above £75, multiple refunds on the same order, or goodwill credits above £15 require team-leader approval.
- AsterLane does not refund consequential losses, such as missed appointments, lost income or the cost of replacement travel.
- Promotional credits have no cash value and are normally returned as account credit rather than cash.

8. Customer communications

- Responses must explain the decision in plain language and identify the evidence used. Agents should avoid internal terms such as 'risk flag' or 'fraud score'.
- Where a claim is declined, the customer should be told what additional evidence may allow the case to be reconsidered.
- Where the knowledge base does not contain a rule for the customer's situation, the agent must not invent one.